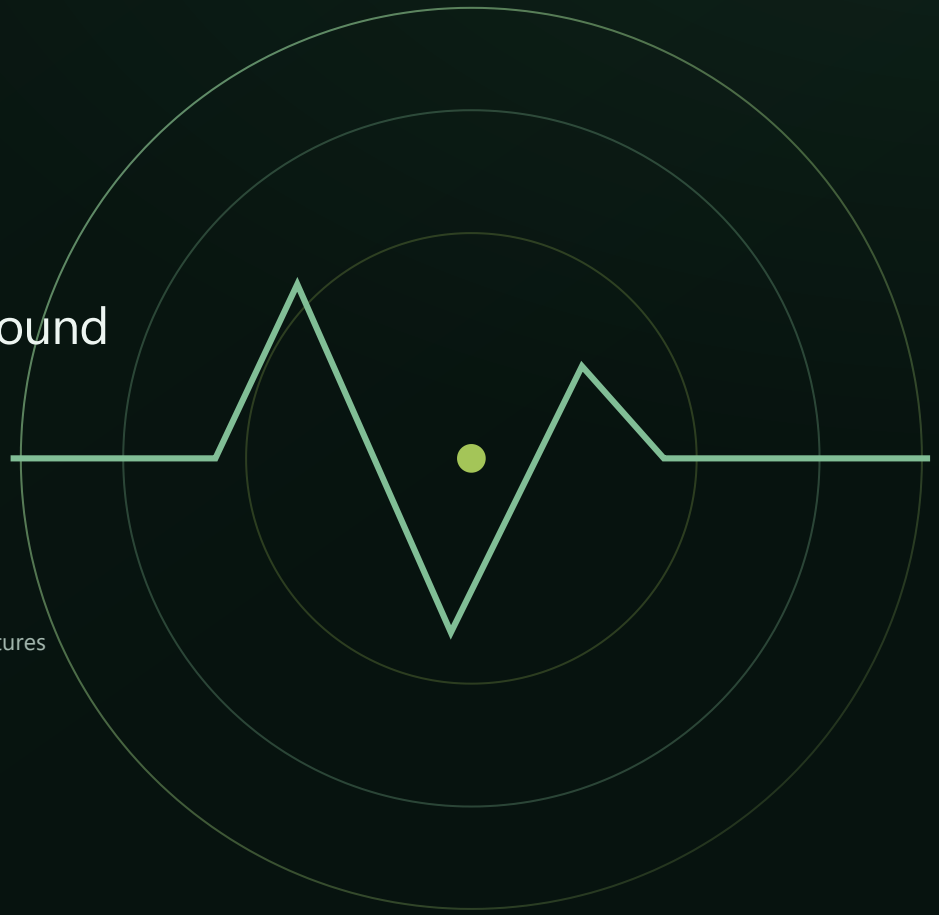
SHAREHOLDER DISCUSSION · UK-FIRST

cre8.

A trusted release workflow for producers and DJs — built around community, permission and repeat use.

VALIDATION PROPOSAL · 11 NOVEMBER 2026



Discussion material only. This is not an investment offer, audited forecast, or evidence of product-market fit. Commercial features and prices remain proposals.

Make the release workflow the reason to return.

Creators share unreleased music across chats, drives and promo tools. cre8 brings permissioned sharing and scene discovery into one focused place.

> “Share unreleased music with the people you choose. Keep your dubs, packs and DJ community organized in one trusted place.”

Positioning direction to test — not approved marketing copy or a claim that the service is leak-proof.

WORKFLOW

Less scattered release admin

Organize packs, sharing and recipients around the music itself.

TRUST

Creator-controlled access

Keep permission and revocation distinct from paid promotion or fan paywalls.

COMMUNITY

Context creates repeat value

Discovery, crates and relationships give the workflow a reason to recur.

A working product foundation; commerce is a separate build.

EXISTING PRODUCT SURFACES

- Dub and Sample Vault discovery, profiles and listening crates
- Ordered packs, sharing and ZIP downloads
- Private and A-List distribution with explicit access grants
- Messaging, notifications and basic creator statistics

PROPOSED / NOT YET DELIVERED

- Checkout, subscription billing and purchase entitlements
- Paid Sample Pack seller onboarding, payouts and refunds
- Advanced analytics, scheduling, team roles and watermarking
- Rights, tax and consumer-law approvals for paid activity

Shareholder takeaway: the pilot should monetize a small, genuinely delivered workflow bundle — not a roadmap or feature list.

Source: cre8 monetization strategy and business plan; product capabilities should be checked against the live release before external circulation.

The whitespace is a combination, not a feature moat.

FREE SUBSTITUTES

Chat + cloud links

Discord, messaging, Dropbox and WeTransfer are familiar and often “good enough” for basic sharing.

Threat: creators may not feel enough pain to switch.

ADJACENT PLATFORMS

Creator & promo tools

SoundCloud, sample subscriptions and label-facing promo products bundle reach, production or campaign features.

Threat: incumbents can add adjacent workflows quickly.

CRE8 HYPOTHESIS

Niche release relationship

Combine trusted community, pack organization and explicitly granted pre-release listening.

Test: does this save repeated effort and bring people back?

> Avoid competing as a smaller SoundCloud. The sharper bet is scene-level trust around creator-controlled access.

Desk research is not a complete competitor census. Public prices are snapshots and are not directly comparable.[1]

Possible position; not demonstrated differentiation or defensibility.

There is category context — but no validated niche market size.

GLOBAL CATEGORY CONTEXT

$15.1B

Electronic music economy

IMS/MIDiA estimate for 2025, up 7% year over year.[2]

Not cre8's addressable market.

UK INDUSTRY CONTEXT

£8B

UK music GVA

UK Music's estimate for the entire UK music industry in 2024.[3]

Not a revenue forecast for this product.

BEHAVIORAL ANALOGUE

~£25

Dubplate cutting

UK services advertise physical cuts from around this price.[4]

Supports cultural relevance, not software willingness to pay.

The commercial question is narrower: will active creators pay repeatedly to solve a real release-sharing problem?

Research found no reliable UK revenue estimate for the target genres. Sample-pack TAM claims and generic freemium benchmarks are excluded from the investment case.

Evidence is directional; paid commitments and renewals matter more.

Start with one paid workflow. Defer the marketplace.

ALWAYS ACCESSIBLE

Free community

£0

- Discovery and ordinary participation
- Basic sharing and access controls
- A-List approval never for sale

PRICE EXPERIMENT

Creator Pro

£9/month

- Test against £7 and £12
- Charge for delivered repeat value
- Keep existing permission controls free

LATER, GATED

Curated Sample Packs

15%

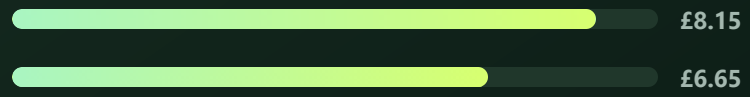
- Proposed platform commission
- Test real packs, price and licence
- Only after rights, tax and payouts work

Optional supporter: £5/month, separate from Pro; not included in the base cash model. These are pricing experiments, not approved or proven prices.[1]

Do not manufacture conversion by restricting ordinary community use.

At 100 registrations, the goal is learning — not founder income.

ILLUSTRATIVE PRO CONTRIBUTION PER £9 SUBSCRIBER



After example payment, billing and 5% refund/dispute reserve; before delivery, support and overheads.

Whole operating allowance: ~24 subscribers if not VAT-registered; ~29 if registered at the same consumer price.

MONTHLY CASH ALLOWANCE

£190

Planning allowance, not a quote; no founder pay.

ILLUSTRATIVE YEAR GROSS

£1,755

Scenario: quarterly averages of 5 / 10 / 20 / 30 Pro users.

ILLUSTRATIVE YEAR RESULT

~£690 shortfall

After estimated subscription contribution versus £2,280 annual cash allowance — before setup, tax, rights costs and founder pay.

Scenarios, not forecasts. Payment fees, VAT status, costs and adoption must be confirmed. See business plan for assumptions.

Cash planning is not statutory profit or an investment return.

Fund a bounded validation phase, not a scale-up.

ILLUSTRATIVE INITIAL CASH HEADROOM

£3.0k–£5.7k

Setup allowances + illustrative first-year shortfall + three-month operating buffer.

IF THERE ARE NO SALES

£4.55k–£7.2k

Setup + one year of operating allowance + three-month buffer.

These are planning allowances, not supplier quotes or a funding commitment. Zero-revenue scenario also excludes rights quotes, founder labour, royalties, tax and major incidents.

What the plan includes

- £1,700–£4,350 one-off setup allowances
- £190/month provisional operating allowance
- Three-month operating buffer: £570
- Founder-led pilot; remain on Render while validating

> Music-rights/licence costs are not included and may materially change the required funding.

No valuation, share price, dilution or equity terms are set in the source plan. Agree any investment structure separately after quotes and legal advice.

Approval requested: quote and validate before committing to scale.

Prove repeat behavior with a small, relevant cohort.

1

Listen

Interview 10 active creators and 5 DJs/listeners about their last real release-share workflow.

2

Recruit

Find 5–10 anchor creators with cleared content and relevant collaborators.

3

Charge honestly

Ask for paid commitments at the shown price; launch only a delivered Pro workflow.

4

Observe renewals

Track repeat use, renewals, support hours, contribution and access incidents.

PROPOSED DECISION GATE · NOT ACHIEVED YET

Five credible paid pilot commitments

Then 5–10 paying pilot creators and at least 4 of the first 5 renewing after two billing cycles.

MEASURE THE RIGHT DENOMINATOR

Eligible active creators, not registrations

A 100-user waitlist is not product-market fit. Track activation, repeat use, paid conversion and renewal separately.

Small-pilot gates are learning thresholds, not statistical proof.

Trust and rights are launch conditions, not footnotes.

Risk	Why it matters	Control / gate
Rights & licensing	Uploaded or sold recordings may include uncleared masters, compositions, samples or performances.	Rights audit and specialist quote; keep affected content out until cleared.
Free substitutes & retention	Chat and cloud links may be sufficient; niche communities can struggle to sustain repeat activity.	Measure recurring workflow pain, return use and renewals; stop or revise if weak.
Payments & consumer duties	Subscriptions, refunds, seller payouts and marketplace tax add legal and operational complexity.	Defer paid packs; approve terms, billing and payout flows before accepting money.
Infrastructure & support	Media delivery, backups and founder support may exceed the small-launch allowance.	Measure media and service costs; cap usage; test restores; reforecast before growth.
Competitive response	Large creator platforms can extend distribution, access and monetization features.	Compete on focused scene relationships and workflow quality; revisit landscape often.

No “leak-proof” promise, guaranteed promotion, exclusive-rights claim or A-List paywall.

Source: UK launch checklist, business plan and positioning research.

Back evidence-gathering before scale.

PROPOSED NEXT DECISION

Approve a UK-first validation phase

- Commission rights, payment and tax quotes
- Recruit a focused creator/listener cohort
- Ship one narrow, delivered Pro workflow
- Review after two paid renewal cycles

This is a proposal for discussion, not a formal shareholder resolution or securities offer.

Do not approve yet

- Broad marketplace launch or seller payouts
- Expensive cloud migration before measured need
- Founder salary or a scale-up hiring plan
- Equity valuation or investment terms not yet modeled

Decision checkpoint: return with actual supplier/legal quotes, paid commitments, usage, renewal data and revised runway.

Research base and disclosure

Supporting cre8 documents

- UK business plan — cash plan, pilot gates and assumptions
- Positioning research — competitor review, demand evidence and confidence limits
- Monetization strategy — price tests and unit-economics assumptions
- UK licensing & payments checklist — unresolved launch gates
- Whole-stack cost model — larger-scale infrastructure sensitivity

Selected external context

1. SoundCloud artist plans and direct sales launch
2. IMS/MIDiA 2025–26 report
3. UK Music 2024 industry GVA
4. Diz Lathe Cuts UK dubplate listings
5. Splice scale (trade reporting)
6. Bandcamp digital fees (comparison only)

Disclosure: Research snapshot 11 November 2026. Figures are planning assumptions or dated public-source context, not independently audited. No validated niche TAM, customer traction, rights clearance, final pricing, legal approval, valuation or investment terms are claimed.

Source prices and platform features can change. Verify all numbers and legal requirements before external use or accepting investment.